contacts were traced and placed in an isolation ward at the same hospital, and their samples collected for testing. Havoc followed at Hinduja Hospital as 82 doctors and frontline workers who had come in contact with the patient had to be isolated and quarantined, since the hospital did not follow any COVID-19 protocol, in the absence of SOPs. The out-patient department was temporarily shut down.[14] A day after being shifted, MP's shortness of breath got worse and his oxygen levels suddenly dropped. Unfortunately, Kasturba Gandhi Hospital was not equipped with an ICU or even a ventilator and MP had to be put on a BiPap machine, instead of a ventilator, in order to stabilize his oxygen concentration. His family pleaded to the hospital authorities and even tried to reach out to the state government to make an effort to shift him back to a facility with a ventilator and an ICU. Sadly, due to the prevailing guidelines, they were not allowed to do so.

The subsequent day, on 14 March, patient MP's oxygen levels dropped further and he passed away.[15] From his primary contacts, his wife and son also tested positive. Due to the prevalent stigma, the building complex where they resided refused to let staff or services reach their door. The family who had tested negative and were quarantined at home were not able to order groceries, their garbage remained uncollected and people were banned from entering their floor. Not only was the loss of a family member devastating, but societal isolation made it insufferable for the family to bear.[16] Panic pausing of Hinduja Hospital due to their staff in isolation was attributed to the rumour that the family had not disclosed MP's travel history (which they did as per the hospital's medical history record). Media hounded the gates of their housing complex and the blame game took centre stage, compounding the stigma they were already facing. Eventually, the Municipal Corporation of Greater Mumbai (MCGM) had to send social workers and councillors to sensitize and educate the neighbours. The grieving wife and son in the adjacent isolation ward at Kasturba Gandhi Hospital were not allowed to see the body. It was wrapped in a plastic body bag, transported to the nearby morgue by officials of the MCGM and the local police. Relatives who had tested negative were not allowed to perform the last rites of the Hindu man or go anywhere near him. The only glimpses they got of their beloved family member were from a distance and that too of the body bag tied up with ropes to a wooden stretcher as it was being